Clyde defense foils Olmsted Falls' strategy

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

TOLEDO — If Olmsted Falls could have put the ball in Tim Schaefer's hands more often Tuesday night, it might have been a different ballgame

But Clyde's defensive scheme made sure that was a very big if in Tuesday night's 56-46 win over the Bulldogs in the Division II regional basketball semifinals at the University of Toledo's Savage Hall.

The Bulldog center was virtually unstoppable in the paint, scoring a team-high 16 points, but his opportunities — 12 shots through four quarters — were few, thanks to a Flier defensive performance that was as good as Olmsted Falls and its coach Pat Donahue have seen all season.

"That's the best defense that's been played against us all year, and the Southwestern Conference plays some of the best defense anywhere," Donahue said "They did a great job defending Tim Schaefer They made our guards work to get the ball to him, and they made him work for every point he got

Donahue refused to let Schaefer speak to reporters after the game

When pressed on why the Bulldogs had so much trouble getting the ball inside to their big gun, Donahue scolded the questioner with his best Bobby Knight postgame interview impression.

"He's (Schaefer) not Ed O'Bannon, is he? And I'm not John Wooden," said Donahue. "This is high school basketball. We made some mistakes, but they (Clyde) had a lot to do with that."

What the Fliers did was harass the Olmsted Falls guards relentlessly as they attempted to get the ball up the court and make the entry pass to the 6-foot-7 sophomore When Schaefer did get the ball, he had Clyde's post duo of 6-6 Ryan J. Carter and 6-5 Nate Morrison waiting for him.

"We knew the key for them (Olmsted Falls) was to get the ball to Schaefer," said Clyde coach Marc Marshall. "Our plan was to go after the people on the outside. We felt like we could pressure their guards. It seemed like when they needed a big play, they hesitated on their passes and we were able to come up with the steal."

The recipients of most of those thefts were lightning-quick Flier guards Ryan Webb and Brian Farrar, who combined to make life miserable for Falls' point guard Chris DeLisio, as well as any other Bulldog player who attempted to bring the ball up the floor.

Olmsted Falls' opening pass to set up its offense more often than not wound up in the hands of one of the Fliers' guards, who anticipated where the ball was going and stepped in the passing lane to get it

"In the tournament we some how have found a way to come up with some big defensive stands," said Marshall, whose Fliers forced 22 Falls turnovers and held the Bulldogs to just 37 percent shooting from the field "It's all come together for us, and defense is a big reason why"

Though visibly upset with what transpired in his squad's third regional appearance in the '90s, Donahue vowed to return.

"We came here to play basketball, and we did that to the best of our abilities," he said. "We lose one senior (DeLisio), and we're going to work our butts off to come back. Tournament experience means nothing if this is what we're satisfied with If we work hard over the summer and get back here, then, yes, this is a positive experience."

Former star wants Elyria back on track

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — A dream became reality for Tim Johnson Monday when he signed a contract to coach boys and girls track at Elyria High.



Johnson

Johnson, a former Pioneer star hurdler, long jumper and sprinter, has been an assistant track coach for 12 years. He also has been on the football staff for 11 seasons

"I know what Pioneer pride and tradition are all about," he said. "That's what I want to get it back to We're starting from ground one, but it won't take long to get it back to where it should be"

Johnson succeeds Tom and Jackie Below, a husband and wife team. Tom coached boys track and Jackie had the girls team.

Johnson has already established some fund-raisers for the Friends of Track, the sport's booster organization

"We're having a barbeque on April 1," he said. "That will be our first fund raiser"

The booster club supplements money from the school system to provide uniforms and equipment for the teams

"For whatever reason, our equipment is down," Johnson said "But one advantage for track is Margaret Cough (Wear) being the athletic director. She has a background in track and is willing to work with us."

Johnson was a prominent member of Elyria High's district and Buckeye Conference championship track team of 1967. He also was a starting halfback on the 1966 football team that had an 8-1-1 record and finished second to Sandusky in the conference

He won The Chronicle-Telegram, Elyria Jaycees Decathlon in 1966, then finished a strong second the following year.

His son Isaac is a three-sport standout at Elyria, and is a strong hurdler on the track team.

"We should have a good team," he said "We'll have good sprinters and good distance runners."

The numbers, though, are not what they were when Johnson ran for Elyria High

"We won't have more than 25 on each team, but that's good for us," he said.

Oberlin's Brice honored

From local and wire reports

COLUMBUS — Oberlin's Cherilyn Brice received honorable mention for the Associated Press Division III girls All-Ohio basketball team.

Brice, a 5-foot-9 junior guard, averaged 14 9 points a game for the Indians this season. She was the only area player to receive all-state mention

Angie Finkes of Springfield Kenton Ridge and Tony Pappas of Wellsville shared player of the year honors. Dan Englisn of Sherwood Fairview, Ed Foulk of Kenton Ridge and Geoff Stevanus of Sugarcreek Garaway shared the coach of the year award.

300 GAME

GARY SCHNEIDER highlighted his 37-year bowling career with his first 300 game Monday. Rolling with the Precise Models Classic at Elyria Bowling Center,

Schneider hit 236 and 207 before concluding with the perfect game for a 743. The Elyrian carries a 208 average

Meet the all-stars

Lorain



Adam Lucas

HEIGHT/POSITION: 6-6, center
LETTERS WON: 2
1994-95 STATS: 228 points, 12.8 ave., 204 rebounds, 10.4 ave.
BASKETBALL HONORS: Second team All-County Division I.
OTHER ACTIVITIES/AWARDS: Top 10 rank in class scholastically, played tight end and defensive end in football.
FUTURE PLANS: Undecided.



Donald Church

HEIGHT/POSITION: 5-9, guard
LETTERS WON: 2
1994-95 STATS: 65 points, 3.5 ave., 40 rebounds, 2.0 ave., 42 assists, 2.2 ave., 50 steals, 2.5 ave.
BASKETBALL HONORS: Top free throw percentage for team.
OTHER ACTIVITIES/AWARDS: Merit roll student; All-Ohio runningback in football, football Player of Year in Erie Shore Conference.



Joe Schwartz

HEIGHT/POSITION: 5-10, guard.
LETTERS WON: 2
1994-95 STATS: 102 points, 5.2 ave., 43 rebounds, 2.3 ave., 24 assists, 1.4 ave , 47 steals, 2.7 ave.
BASKETBALL HONORS: As sophomore had top free throw percentage and scoring average on junior varsity team.
OTHER ACTIVITIES/AWARDS: National Honor Society and German Club; Two soccer and three baseball letters; First team All-County in baseball.
FUTURE PLANS: Bowling Green University to study physical therapy.



Greg Williams

HEIGHT/POSITION: 5-10, guard
LETTERS WON: 3
1994-95 STATS: 256 points, 12.8 ave; 45 rebounds; steals 3.4 ave.; assists 3 8 ave.
BASKETBALL HONORS: Second team All-County Division I, second team All-Conference Erie Shore Conference, tri-captain of team.
OTHER ACTIVITIES/AWARDS: 3.9 grade average, National Honor Society, Top Ten per cent of his class, three-year football letterman, All-Conference first team special mention All-State.
FUTURE PLANS: Undecided on college choice, but will study pre-law.

THE 16TH ANNUAL *Lorain County Senior Boys All-Star Basketball Games will be Mar 31 at Lorain Catholic High School. The evening, sponsored by the Lorain County Boys Basketball Coaches Association and The Chronicle-Telegram, will feature two games at 6 p.m. and 8 p.m. Inbetween games will be Coca-Cola's presentation of the 1995 Lorain County Mr. Basketball Award and the Coaches Association Hall of Fame induction ceremonies. Tickets at $4 each will be available at the door*

VOLLEYBALL

KEYSTONE CATPAW CLASSIC: Keystone High School will host the Keystone Catpaw Classic co-ed volleyball tournament on Saturday, March 25. Entry fee is $75 per team. Teams must have a minimum of two female players. Play gets under way at 10 a.m. To register, call Dave Cross 355-5133 (school) or 365-3329 (home). The tourney is being held to raise funds for the Keystone volleyball program.

BULLDOGS

From B1

of the fourth period

But with 6 08 left in the game they only trailed by three points, 43-40, and were still in contention Two big baskets by Tim Schaefer, a 6-foot-7 sophomore, and a 3-pointer from Chris DeLisio rallied Falls from an eight point deficit, 39-31 to only trail by two going into the final quarter

Things fell apart then, however, when Clyde's Ryan Webb stole the ball and drove in for a layup to make it 45-40 with 4 30 left The Bulldogs didn't get their first field goal of the quarter until just 1:41 remained and they were eight points back, 50-42 They could get no closer the rest of the way

'Game in and game out we somehow find a way to come up big," Clyde Coach Marc Marshall said. "When we need a big play, we get it."

Clyde shot 40 percent from the field to 36 percent for Olmsted Falls and out-rebounded the taller Bulldogs 40-38. A big difference was in ball handling. The Fliers had only 12 turnovers, the Bulldogs 22

Olmsted Falls, which finished the season with a 17-7 record, will have most of its team back Only DeLisio will graduate among the starters.

CLYDE (56)						
Players	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P
Ryan C Webb	13	7	11	5	3	19
Jeff Pa	14	4	7	4	3	12
Brian Webb	8	4	2	2	3	10
Kyle Tomson	8	3	4	0	2	6
Brian Farra	5	2	0	0	1	5
Ryan D Carter	3	1	0	0	2	2
Greg Robinson	1	0	2	2	0	2
Tony Daileal	0	0	0	0	0	0
Bill Binder	0	0	0	0	0	0
Roy Salazar	0	0	0	0	1	0
Jim Anderson	0	0	0	0	0	0
TOTALS	52	21	26	13	15	56

OLMSTED FALLS (56)						
Players	GA	G	FA	FT	F	P
Tim Schaefe	12	6	6	4	3	16
Chris DeLisio	9	3	6	3	1	9
Jason Storey	5	2	3	2	3	6
Nick Neumeister	2	2	2	1	4	5
Matt Tabar	7	1	0	0	5	3
Kevin Morin	4	1	2	1	3	3
Mike Seppenbacher	3	1	0	0	2	2
Scott Johnson	2	1	0	0	0	2
Jerome Moore	2	0	0	0	1	0
Jim Kaemba	0	0	0	0	0	0
Luke Higgins	0	0	0	0	0	0
Andy Montiak	0	0	0	0	0	0
TOTALS	46	17	13	8	20	46

Score by Quarters

Clyde	12	12	17	15	— 56
Olmsted Falls	9	15	15	7	— 46

Three-Point Goals Clyde—Brian Farrar, Olmsted Falls—Chris DeLisio 3 Matt Tabar uBrookside-Mark Williams 3 Jarrod Van Horn, Brent Schremp Elyria West-Shawn Hill 4

LORAIN

From B1

Association sponsored the event Now, in its final year as a high school, Lorain is back in the Sweet Sixteen again.

Tempo will be a key for the Steelmen, who cannot hope to win if the game goes up and down the 94-foot court at a brisk pace. Lorain must slow it down, keep the game under control and try to frustrate a talented team

But it's questionable whether Lorain can hold Euclid to less than 50 points, as the Steelmen have against opponents in every tournament game so far

"They're good," said Rositano of Euclid. "They're a very athletic team and tough to handle. I'm not sure we can hold this team to 40, but we want to make them work for their shots If we can hold them to 50, we have an excellent chance."

Along with defense, Lorain's strong suit, go offensive discipline and rebounding.

"We must control the tempo," said Rositano. "If we go up and down with them, we're in deep trouble. We want to control the tempo with our offense, play good defense and rebound. If we can do that, we can beat anybody"

Euclid is led by 6 foot-4 Mel Levett, one of the state's best players He played at Villa Angela/St. Joseph last year and led the Vikings to a state championship in Division II, scoring 32 points in the final game against Wauseon.

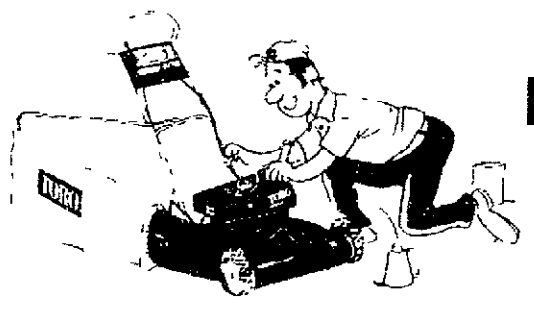
"But they've got more than Levett," Rositano said. "They've got a 6-6 kid named Tucker who's a player. In one game I saw he had four dunks and 10 blocked shots. And they've got a good point guard named Cunningham. He didn't play in some of the games they lost."

Lorain will counter with 6-2 junior Carl White, who averages around 16 points a game. Center Adam Lucas, a 6-6 senior, and guard Greg Williams also are double-figures scorers.

Freshman Londie Ransom is a capable 3-point shooter and senior Joe Schwarz is a tough defensive player who probably will guard Levett.

Appearing in the regional has increased the enthusiasm at Lorain High. In a three-hour span Monday the school sold nearly 700 tickets, Rositano said.

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